

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
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PRESENTENCE REPORT**

Public Docket Surrogate for Sealed Defendant Sentencing Memorandum

Filed: February 19, 2026 **Synthetic docket:** SYN-MDNC-25-CR-0328 **Public docket entry:** DE35

This surrogate records the filing and category structure of Mateo Serrano's sealed sentencing memorandum. It is not the memorandum, a redacted version, or a public presentence report. Celia Arden submitted the protected filing on February 19, 2026, for consideration at sentencing.

The public entry identifies the memorandum as addressing the advisory calculation, a preserved role objection, statutory sentencing factors, personal mitigation, and requested relief. Confidential content is replaced by category notices. The corresponding sealed exercise volume is SEN-SV-1, available only through a separate fictional workbench authorization.

The public and sealed documents use matching page subjects so stable references can resolve according to access. Their prose is independently composed, and matching positions do not expose the sealed content. The memorandum's existence and filing date may be seen on the public docket; its evidence, personal-history discussion, and specific sentencing advocacy remain nonpublic under the applicable automatic-sealing rules.

Requested-Sentence Category

The second section of the sealed memorandum states the defense's requested sentence. This public page records that a concrete request was made but substitutes [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY—SENTENCING POSITION] for its substance. It does not reveal a term of imprisonment, a proposed placement, or supporting personal facts.

The request is presented as an exercise of the court's discretion after calculation of the advisory range. It is not described here as compelled by the plea agreement, and the public surrogate does not suggest that the government agreed. The plea left the disputed role adjustment open for decision.

Public users may infer only that defense counsel asked Judge Elara Venn to select a sentence under the statutory framework after considering all properly presented information. The protected twin explains the position and its relationship to the role dispute. This surrogate neither predicts the court's ruling nor reports a sentence. It supplies docket transparency while preventing confidential advocacy or history from being reconstructed through a nominally public counterpart.

Advisory-Range Category

The memorandum contains a Guidelines section associated with [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY–GUIDELINE CALCULATION]. That section addresses the effect of the unresolved aggravating-role objection on the advisory range. The public surrogate identifies the subject but withholds the calculations and party-specific recommendation.

The section uses the 2025 Guidelines Manual because the charged conspiracy continued after its effective date. It does not invoke a later manual or later-issued authority. The plea agreement preserved the court's responsibility to determine the disputed adjustment at sentencing.

Nothing in this category notice states which range defense counsel believes controls, whether the court will adopt an adjustment, or how the statutory factors should affect the ultimate sentence. Those matters appear only in SEN-SV-1. The public page confirms that counsel addressed the calculation rather than omitting it. It contains no presentence-report text, personal identifier, criminal-history detail, or confidential factual assertion. The category is therefore a map of an advocacy subject, not public disclosure of the sealed memorandum's analysis.

Statutory-Factor Category

The next portion is indexed as a discussion of the sentencing factors in 18 U.S.C. § 3553(a). It includes categories concerning the nature of the offense, the history and characteristics of the defendant, deterrence, protection of the public, available sentencing choices, and avoidance of unwarranted disparity.

Protected offense discussion is replaced by [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY—OFFENSE CONDUCT]. Defendant-specific material is divided between [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY—PERSONAL HISTORY] and [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY—MITIGATION HISTORY]. The categories disclose no event, diagnosis, family circumstance, employer, address, or other underlying fact.

This public page does not announce how the defense balances the factors or the weight requested for any category. It confirms only that the sealed memorandum addresses the statutory framework in advance of the hearing. The category structure allows the court and authorized participants to align public and sealed exercise references without treating the surrogate as a summary. A reader cannot determine the requested outcome from the placeholders alone, and no appellate consequence is stated or implied.

Preserved Role-Objection Category

Defense counsel incorporates the unresolved objection to the proposed § 3B1.1(b) adjustment. The public counterpart labels that section [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY—ROLE ANALYSIS] and notes that it concerns alleged management or supervision of another criminally responsible person.

The legal boundary is public: the dispute does not depend on management of assets, property, or activities alone. The confidential filing supplies the defense's factual analysis and requested calculation. This surrogate does not reveal the alleged supervisee, describe any communication, or characterize the strength of the parties' evidence.

The section remains relevant to sentencing because the role finding affects the initial advisory calculation. Its inclusion does not create a new objection, alter the plea, or indicate that the court has decided the matter. The docket records that the issue was preserved through the February 19 submission for resolution at the February 24 hearing. Any protected linkage to the presentence report remains within SEN-SV-1 and its associated sealed materials. The public notice states a category and procedural posture only.

Defense-Mitigation Category

The sixth section collects the principal defense mitigation submission. Its public marker is [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY—MITIGATION HISTORY], with related personal material represented by [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY—PERSONAL HISTORY]. The sealed twin contains the actual presentation.

The category includes subjects that defense counsel asks the court to consider under § 3553(a), but this page does not list events, relationships, treatment information, employment details, or the words of any proposed statement. It also does not reveal the weight or sentencing outcome counsel requests from those subjects.

The category's presence confirms that mitigation was placed before the court before sentence. That procedural fact may matter to later review of the hearing record, yet the public surrogate does not state what any person would have said or how the court responded. Public access to DE35 gives no permission to open SEN-SV-1. The two projections share a stable page subject solely so an authorized workbench session can resolve the proper counterpart without exposing confidential information to an unauthorized reader.

Remorse and Treatment Categories

The sealed memorandum has a section indexed under two high-level subjects: remorse and treatment progress. For the public record, both are represented by [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY—MITIGATION HISTORY]. No program name, provider, location, schedule, medical fact, or personal statement appears here.

The surrogate confirms that defense counsel presented those categories as relevant to sentencing. It does not say that the government accepted the assertions, that the court made a finding, or that a particular sentence follows from them. The protected filing contains any narrative needed for judicial consideration.

This separation avoids disclosing sensitive information while preserving the docket's chronology and completeness. The categories were submitted on February 19, five days before the scheduled hearing, through the synthetic sealed channel. No real probation or health record is involved. The public category page is deliberately insufficient to reconstruct the underlying mitigation, and its matched position in the sealed twin is an exercise navigation device rather than a statement that the two texts are interchangeable.

Caregiving and Work Categories

Another section concerns caregiving responsibilities and stable lawful work. Those subjects are jointly replaced by [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY–PERSONAL HISTORY] and [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY–MITIGATION HISTORY]. This page names general categories only and omits every personal relationship, schedule, workplace, duty, address, and supporting declaration.

The sealed defense memorandum explains why counsel believes the categories bear on the statutory sentencing analysis. The public surrogate does not disclose the requested inference or compare Serrano with another defendant. Nor does it state whether the information appears elsewhere in the presentence materials.

DE35 therefore provides notice that a personal-history presentation was made while preserving the confidentiality expected for sentencing information. SEN-SV-1 remains a distinct, controlled exercise volume. The fictional clerk's public entry cannot be used to obtain that volume, and a workbench access grant is not access to any real filing platform. No finding or sentence is recorded on this page because the memorandum preceded the hearing and the categories remained part of advocacy.

Variance-Analysis Category

The memorandum includes a variance analysis marked [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY—SENTENCING POSITION]. It connects the defense's statutory-factor presentation to a requested exercise of sentencing discretion. The public surrogate records the existence of that argument without disclosing its amount, rationale, or proposed conditions.

This category is separate from the Guidelines objection. One addresses the correct advisory calculation; the other addresses the sentence the court should select after calculating the range. The public entry preserves that distinction so the docket does not misleadingly collapse all defense advocacy into a single adjustment dispute.

The sealed memorandum may refer to confidential mitigation and offense information in developing the variance request. None of those references appears here. [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY—MITIGATION HISTORY], [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY—OFFENSE CONDUCT], and [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY—PERSONAL HISTORY] remain placeholders, not summaries. The page does not predict whether Judge Venn will vary, impose a Guidelines sentence, or choose any particular term. It is a category index for a filing made before judgment.

Requested-Disposition Category

The concluding advocacy section asks the district court to impose the defense's requested sentencing disposition after resolving the role objection and considering § 3553(a). Its substance remains [NONPUBLIC PSR CATEGORY—SENTENCING POSITION] in this public view.

The conclusion also addresses financial and supervision components at a categorical level. The surrogate does not disclose proposed amounts, duration, conditions, or the precise relationship between those components and the imprisonment request. It shows only that counsel presented a complete sentencing proposal rather than an argument limited to Guidelines arithmetic.

No aspect of this page records what the court later imposed. The sealed filing was advocacy on February 19, and its paired public entry must remain temporally faithful to that posture. It contains no appellate ruling, later authority, or prediction of review. The public category can be cited to establish that a sentencing position existed, but not as evidence of its details. Authorized users must consult SEN-SV-1 through the fictional controlled projection for the actual exercise text.

Filing and Service Certification

Celia Arden certifies that the sealed defendant sentencing memorandum was submitted on February 19, 2026, to Judge Venn through the synthetic court channel. Service was recorded for Bram Ives and Niko Faye. The public surrogate was entered as DE35; the independently written sealed companion was recorded as SEN-SV-1.

This certification discloses no genuine address, email, account, credential, or filing path. It confirms only the filing date, participating fictional offices, page-subject structure, and paired-access designation. The sealed memorandum remains protected because it draws on presentence and personal-history material.

Tessa Wren records that the public counterpart contains category labels and procedural metadata, not redacted substantive text. It should not be called a public presentence report or treated as a substitute for the defense filing. The workbench may expose SEN-SV-1 only under a separate synthetic authorization and may withdraw that projection without changing DE35. No ruling, sentence, or appellate disposition is certified because none had occurred when counsel filed the memorandum.